

off and thus a little light escapes here and there resulting in a bit of grey tinge being displayed rather than absolute black. OLED panels have LEDs instead of a tube backlight and each pixel has it's own little LED backlight which can be switched off to ensure absolute blackness.

3D Monitors: These monitors are designed for a better 3D viewing experience. Normal monitors can display 3D content but with low refresh rates it is difficult to make sense of a scenario with a lot of rapid movement on the screen, 3D monitors have higher refresh rates (120 Hz) which reduces the ghosting effect.

Touchscreen monitors: While desktop monitors aren't seeing a lot of touchscreen monitors the laptop market is quite the opposite specially after the launch of Windows 8 which has a tablet like interface in place of the traditional Start Button menu. They are pretty much like mobile touchscreens with multi-touch capabilities. The panel technology is the same as normal monitors with the exception of having a digitizer layer added on the top of the panel.

Parameters / Specifications

Contrast Ratio

Quite simply put the monitor's contrast ratio is the difference between the two extreme levels of brightness - absolute black and maximum brightness. There is no standard to measuring contrast ratio which gave rise to idiotic marketing terminology such as Dynamic Contrast Ratio. Ideally contrast ratio refers to the difference in brightness levels with the backlight kept static, i.e. the brightness of the backlight remains the same while the picture on the screen is turned to white / black. What Dynamic contrast ratio refers to is when the backlight is varied along with the image on screen. So a dark image is measured with the backlight set to the absolute minimum (a scenario which will never be reproduced during normal usage) and then a white image with the backlight set to a level higher than what a consumer model comes with. The resulting ratio is quite high, you see contrast ratios ranging in the millions. Always compare monitors with the actual contrast ratio and not dynamic.

Pixel pitch

Pixel pitch / dot pitch refers to the space between the pixels on the screen. The smaller the pixel pitch the more dense the panel is and thus better your image quality becomes.